

WACHID RIDWAN

Personal Information:

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DOB: Demak, February 6, 1971
Nationality: Indonesia
Status: Married

Education:

Padjadjaran University Bandung (2015-current)
Doctoral Program of International Relations, Faculty of Social and Political Sciences.
Dissertation: International Cooperation on Counter Terrorism in Indonesia

University of Indonesia (1999-2002)

M. Si (Post Graduate) Political Science Faculty majoring in International Relations
Thesis: President Habibie's Self-determination Option on East Timor Popular
Consultation in 1999 (Study of Decision Making Process)

Muhammadiyah University of Malang (1990-1994)

S. Pd. (Bachelor Degree) Education faculty majoring in English Language
Script: An Analysis on Unity of Style through Diction of the Sun also Rises Novel

Trainings:

1. Management Crisis, US Embassy Jakarta (2002)
2. Political Tradecraft at Foreign Service Institute (FSI) US Department of State, Washington, DC (2003)
3. U4 Anti-Corruption Training Workshop in Jakarta and On Line Course (2008)
4. Basic International Cooperation on line course, The Netherlands Ministry of Foreign Affairs (2013)

Work Experiences:

1994-1996

Taught English for Specific Purposes (ESP) at the Muhammadiyah University of Malang, where for four years I studied at this university. I had been more teaching in the Department of Communication for students of the beginning semester.

1997-1998

Through recommendation of Chairman of Foreign Relations of the Central Board of Muhammadiyah, I traveled to the United States to join with non-governmental organization (NGO) World Citizen Diplomats (WCD) in Princeton. I assisted in preparation of World Peace Caravan program supported by the United Nations NGO, Lifebridge Foundation, to promote world peace day in year 2000. With funding support from Lifebridge amounted to USD 10.000, the WCD was organizing a trip to campaign peace along mainland Canada in 1997 and with additional funding again from Lifebridge in 1998, WCD and I travelled in Western Europe and Scandinavia for peace campaign.

1999-2006

Worked with the U.S. Embassy in Jakarta as a political assistant, I handled portfolios of political Islam and Aceh. This function becomes more important when the terrorist attacks against the World Trade Centre happened in the year 2001. The Embassies in dire needed of public diplomacy to the largest Muslim populated country in the world, Indonesia. I had set up a private meeting between Ambassador and the leaders of Islamic mass organizations for several times as well as many times direct dialogue with all elements of Islam including hard-line Islamic groups in Jakarta.

A similar situation also occurred during the war in Afghanistan and Iraq which were extremely infuriated Indonesian Muslims against the United States. I had tried my best to help the Embassy to be able to establish good relations with mainstream groups of Islamic organizations such as Muhammadiyah and Nahdlatul Ulama also with other Islamic elements. At the same situation it also raised issue of terrorism that resulted in more and more difficult to build trust between the Embassy and the Islamic community. But with the various efforts and approaches, distributing of booklets on Islam in USA throughout Islamic Boarding school in Indonesia and granting thousands of school bags and its equipment, its gradually improved better relations.

During some visits of the VIP and a VVIP, I was always involved in helping its success. When President George W. Bush visited Indonesia in 2003, the President intended to meet with Islamic leaders who eventually became a long polemic in the Indonesian medias by questioning what the need for the meeting. Some clerics commented that there was no use for doing meeting, although eventually the meeting was truly happened.

I routinely made reports on the development of the human rights situation in Aceh, especially on conflict between the Free Aceh Movement (GAM) and Indonesian National Army (TNI). I intensively communicated with Acehnese student leaders and youth groups as well as women group to discuss peace in Aceh. On a different topic, I also made a report on the development of Islamic sharia implementation in some areas in Indonesia and generally described the dynamic of Islam in Indonesia. During the last four years working at the Embassy, I contributed in the writing of the State Department annual report of human rights on Indonesia, and also an International Religious Freedom in Indonesia and few reports' input on Child Labour in Indonesia.

2006- February 2015

Working with the Netherlands Embassy, I am not only supporting better Dutch policy implementation for political situation in Indonesia but also handling Dutch project developments aid to Indonesia. I still regularly make reports on internal dynamic of politic in Indonesia such as political parties and parliament standing on important public issues, the Islamic mass organizations role in society, the development of the human rights situation in Indonesia particularly in conflict areas like in Aceh and Maluku.

At the moment I am handling a direct bilateral cooperation for the economic empowerment in Karawang through establishing community cooperative and infrastructure constructions. The first program is supported by Hivos, while the infrastructure projects will be run by the Interior Ministry of the Republic of Indonesia. I arranged a grant of USD 1 million for both projects which supposed to be finished last 2012 but was extended until end of this year.

Through project Election- Multi Donor Program (E-MDP/UNDP), the Embassy has helped to success of election in 2009, while the program continued to run for voters' civic education which was lasted in 2011. This project was awarded USD 2 million by Dutch government and two third of the grant was devoted for the socialization and the rest was for establishing Center for Civic Education (CEC) programs for 2014 election.

Many of Dutch development projects are both run through multilateral and bilateral cooperation. I managed and monitored projects development in post-conflict Maluku with total budget of about USD 4 million for four years undertaken by UNDP. This project was devoted to restore mutual trust in the Islamic and Christian communities who had been involved in a bloody conflict to be together again without any segregation in society. This project also intended to produce guidance of development in sensitive prone conflicts areas in Indonesia.

I closely guided a project activity with Wahid Institute on religious pluralism for young people and students in Indonesia. This activity was carried out in cooperation between Wahid Institute (WI) and PeaceTech from the Philippines with full funding from the Netherlands Embassy. Among successful activities in counselling religious pluralism was a video conference between several cities in Indonesia by involving students and youth from interfaith groups. This was very good software to seed spirit of tolerance among young people whose different background in many aspects.

For three years (2009-2012), the Dutch Embassy supported The Asia Foundation (TAF) on the project activity which had three main objectives such as protection and promotion of religious freedom; increased women's participation in public and politics and improved accessibility and quality of reproductive health. The outcomes as specified in the project proposal have been achieved. Although the project has contributed to the promotion of religious freedom, the protection of religious minorities is still a concern as of today, especially in areas where radical groups seem to be strongly present.

Organization Experience:

Since a student at the Muhammadiyah University of Malang I actively participated in leadership activities which eventually led me to be selected by majority votes as a student coordinator commissariat of Muhammadiyah Students Association (IMM). This experience has led me to a more active level, ie, at East Java province and after finishing my under graduate I joined the student council leadership of Muhammadiyah in Jakarta.

At the Muhammadiyah congress in 2000, I was appointed by the Executive Central leadership to sit as deputy secretary general for foreign relations for one period until 2004 and in 2005 during the Congress as well, I was appointed as the vice chairman of foreign relations. Currently, I am sitting as Secretary General at the same bureau and has successfully register Muhammadiyah to obtain Consultative Status with ECOSOC effective since 1 August 2011.

Awards:

US Embassy Employee of the month (August, 2001)
US Department of State Meritorious Honour Award (2002)
US Embassy Extra Miles (2003)
US Department of State Meritorious Honour Award Group (2003)
Embassy of the Kingdom of the Netherlands Best Performance (2007)